Ford Motor Company

Service Recall Bulletin

May 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Supplement #1: Special Action – Aftermarket Hitch Kits and Existing Dealer Stock

REFERENCE: Safety Recall 00S05: All 1997-2000 Model Year Expedition and Navigator with Trailer Hitch Package -- Hitch Attachment

Revisions have been marked with a vertical line (|) and online text will be green. Please discard all previous copies of 00S05 and replace them with this supplement.

AFFECTED VEHICLES

All 1997 through 2000 model year Expedition and Navigator vehicles equipped with factory-installed trailer hitch, and built at the Michigan Truck Assembly Plant from Job #1, 1997 through December 9, 1999.

SAFETY ISSUE

In some of the affected vehicles the trailer hitch attaching bolts may lose clamp load potentially allowing the trailer hitch to separate from the vehicle.

SERVICE ACTION

At no cost to the owner, dealers will remove the hitch assembly, clean the mounting surfaces and reinstall the hitch assembly using updated attaching hardware, and apply anti-corrosion compound to the frame.

LINCOLN COMMITMENT SPECIAL HANDLING PROCEDURE (Navigator Owners Only)

The Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure has been activated for all Lincoln owners affected by this recall. Please see dealer announcement dated 12/17/98, Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure (Attachment IV). The special handling procedure provides additional allowance to enable dealers to offer Lincoln owners convenient vehicle handling.

Lincoln Mercury is asking for your support and the cooperation of your sales and service teams to make this a positive experience for our Navigator customers, many of whom are new to the Lincoln family.

SPECIAL ACTION

CUSTOMERS WHO PURCHASED AFTERMARKET HITCH KITS

Approximately 6,900 owners of the affected 1997 through 2000 Model Year Expedition/Navigator vehicles have purchased *aftermarket* hitch kits from their Ford or Lincoln Mercury dealer. If a dealer is aware of any customer who purchased aftermarket hitch kit, service part number F75Z-17D826-AE, either for installation at the dealership or independently, please:

1. call Recall Hotline at 1-800-325-5621 for instructions and prior approval
2. contact these customers and provide them with a copy of the attached Safety Recall 00S05 Owner Letter.

Claims without prior approval will be returned to dealer unpaid.

REWORK OF EXISTING DEALER STOCK

Call the Recall Hotline at 1-800-325-5621, to obtain instructions for reworking existing stock of Trailer Hitch Kits (part # F75Z-17D826-AE).

NOTE: The Recall Hotline will provide new hardware and kit installation instructions. When you rework dealer stock, please make sure these revised instructions (with new torque specifications) are included in the kit.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I:	Administrative Information
Attachment II:	Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III:	Technical Information
Attachment IV:	Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure Announcement Letter
Attachment V:	Owner Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……...1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

Safety Recall 00S05-S1
All 1997-2000 Model Year Expedition and Navigator with Trailer Hitch Package
Trailer Hitch Attachment

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $1,100 per vehicle.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC) or by FAX. Also, correct other eligible vehicles which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date. This contact includes owners who have purchased aftermarket hitch kit # F75Z-17D826-AE.

Note: Navigator owners should receive the " Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure".

Before calling Lincoln owners, review Attachment IV to familiarize yourself with this special handling procedure.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.
- To claim for the "Lincoln Commitment Special Handling", follow the instructions on page two of Attachment IV.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

Only Navigator owners are eligible for rental cars under the provisions of the "Lincoln Commitment Special Handling Procedure" (refer to Attachment IV).

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Trailer Hitch Attachment

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Install Trailer Hitch Fastener Kit	00S05B	0.7 Hours
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour
Lincoln Commitment Special Handling*	Misc. Expense Code "LCHP"	See Attachment IV

* Lincoln Commitment Special Handling does not apply to vehicles in dealer stock.

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Order your parts requirement through normal order processing channels as noted below:

Stock Orders	Effective immediately	Normal order process
Interim Orders	Effective immediately	Normal order process
Emergency Orders	First 30 days after launch	Call 1-800-325-5621
Emergency Orders	31 days after launch	Normal order process

Part Number	***Description***	***Quantity***
YL1Z-17D826-CA	Hitch Fastener Kit	1
F6AZ-2C410-AB	Brake Metal Cleaner (case of 12) (or equivalent product)	1 can per vehicle

MATERIAL ALLOWANCE

A material allowance of $5.25 per vehicle is being given to purchase an underbody coating (Super Seal or equivalent product). Claim this allowance by entering the following:

Part Number	***Description***	***Amount***
OSP	Underbody Coating	$ 5.25

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SPECIAL ORDER INFORMATION

DOR/COR number 50161 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Recall Hotline (800-325-5621), for the first 30 days.

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NOTE: The Recall Hotline will provide new hardware and kit installation instructions. When you rework dealer stock, please make sure these revised instructions (with new torque specifications) are included in the kit.

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

Program Announcement Letter
Lincoln Commitment Special Handling

Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P.O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121

December 17, 1998

To: All Lincoln Mercury and Ford Dealers

cc: Parts Managers
Service Managers

Subject: Announcing Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure for Certain Recalls and Owner Notification Programs

As part of our ongoing commitment to Lincoln customers, we are pleased to announce the Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure to provide additional dealer compensation for certain Recalls and Owner Notification Programs(ONP's) that affect Lincoln brand vehicles.

This additional compensation is being provided to allow dealers to provide personalized service designed to make the recall repair a positive experience for the Lincoln customer, many of whom are new to the Lincoln family.

Each Recall/ONP Bulletin affecting Lincoln vehicles will indicate whether the Lincoln Commitment Special Customer Handling Procedure is authorized; please note that not every Recall/ONP will qualify for this procedure and that the procedure will not be communicated to customers as a normal benefit of the Lincoln Commitment Program. Special handling and claiming instructions are included on the attached page. This program will apply only to Lincoln vehicles which have been delivered to customers.

We ask you to make maximum usage of these special enhancements to the Lincoln Commitment Program when applicable. Thank you in advance for your support of this program and our commitment to surprise and delight our Lincoln customers.

/O.S.B./
Mark Hutchins
President
Lincoln Mercury

/O.S.B./
M. D. Jordan
Executive Director
Ford Customer Service Division
North America

Lincoln Commitment Special Handling (Continued)

If Dealer Picks up and Returns Vehicle for Customer:

Special Service	Dealer Compensation	Claim Procedure
• Pick up the customer's vehicle (at a location of their preference such as home or place of business) and return after repair* • Drop off comparable loaner vehicle • Refill fuel tank • Wash and vacuum vehicle • Return vehicle to customer after repair is completed	Up to 2 hours additional labor (converted to a dollar amount) plus actual cost of fuel and wash/vacuum Note: Labor time to fill tank and wash/vacuum has been included in 2 hour allowance Labor subject to time recording procedures as outlined in Warranty & Policy Manual	Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash/vacuum) using Misc. Expense Code "LCHP" EXAMPLE (using example labor rate of $58/hour and fuel cost of $1.05/gallon): 1.2 hrs. labor* = $69.60 9.0 gals fuel = 9.45 Wash/vacuum = 3.50 Total Submitted = $82.55 *travel time+fueling/washing labor
Provide comparable loaner vehicle to customer when vehicle is picked up	Actual cost up to a maximum of $35 per day for a Lincoln loaner or up to $18 per day for a Mercury or Ford loaner (This does not count against TAP allocation)	Submit up to 3 days maximum using "LOANER" (if additional days are required, call 1-800-325-5621 for authorization)
Perform Recall/ONP repair at dealership	Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified in Recall/ONP Bulletin	See applicable Recall/ONP Bulletin

*Or repair on-site if appropriate; if on-site repair is performed, rental charges do not apply.

If Customer Brings Vehicle to Dealer:

Special Service	Dealer Compensation	Claim Procedure
Perform Recall/ONP repair at dealership	Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified in Recall/ONP Bulletin	See applicable Recall/ONP Bulletin
Provide comparable loaner vehicle to customer	Actual cost up to a maximum of $35 per day for a Lincoln loaner or up to $18 per day for a Mercury or Ford loaner (This does not count against TAP allocation)	Submit up to 3 days maximum using "LOANER" (if additional days are required, call 1-800-325-5621 for authorization)
Refill fuel tank and wash/ vacuum vehicle	Up to 0.5 hour additional labor (converted to a dollar amount) plus actual cost of fuel and wash/vacuum	Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash/vacuum) using Misc. Expense Code "LCHP"

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
1-800-392-3673
www.ownerconnection.com

May 2000

00S05

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in all 1997-2000 model year Expedition and Navigator vehicles with a factory-installed trailer hitch package.

What the safety issue is…

In some of the affected vehicles, the trailer hitch attaching bolts may loosen over time. This condition may cause an audible noise and may lead to a partial separation of the hitch from the vehicle. Continued use of a vehicle with loosened fasteners may lead to complete hitch separation from the vehicle.

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do...

At no cost to you, your dealer will remove the hitch assembly, clean the mounting surfaces and reinstall the hitch assembly using updated attaching hardware at a higher torque.

How long will it take?

The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

What we are asking you to do…

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date and whether parts are in stock for Safety Recall 00S05.

If your dealer does not have the parts in stock, they can be ordered before scheduling your service date. Parts would be expected to arrive within a week after ordering.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you

misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you've already paid for this service…

If you paid to have your hitch fasteners tightened before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a full refund. For the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your Ford or Lincoln Mercury dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

Return to your Ford or Lincoln Mercury dealer to have the updated hitch attaching hardware installed at a higher torque.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle…

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns…

If you have questions, please contact us through the internet at *www.ownerconnection.com* Our current response time to internet inquires is three business days.

You may also call the Ford Motor Company North American Customer Assistance Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: 8am - 11pm Monday through Friday and 9am - 6pm Saturday (Eastern Time)

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline at 1-800-424-9393 (Washington, D. C. area residents may call 1-202-366-0123).

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Again, we are sorry for the inconvenience. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs